TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 34

Date: | **Supervisor:**

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: **Electrical Safety & GFCI Requirements**

OVERVIEW:

Electrocution is the fourth leading cause of worker fatalities in construction. On finish carpentry jobs, the primary electrical hazards are damaged extension cords, improper grounding of power tools, and wet conditions near temporary power. Ground fault circuit interrupters are the single most

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. A ground fault circuit interrupter — GFCI — continuously monitors the current flowing through a circuit and detects when current is leaking to ground, which happens when a person becomes part of the electrical circuit. The GFCI detects this imbalance and interrupts the circuit in as little as 1/40th of a second — fast enough to prevent cardiac arrest in most cases. All 120-volt receptacles
2. Extension cords must be inspected before every use. Look for cuts in the insulation, exposed bare wire, bent or damaged plugs, missing ground prongs, and splices or repairs with tape. A damaged extension cord that energizes during use can deliver a fatal shock to anyone who contacts the damaged area. Remove any damaged cord from service immediately. Do not tape insulation damage —
3. When a GFCI trips repeatedly, there is a ground fault in the circuit, the tool, or the cord. Do not reset a repeatedly-tripping GFCI and continue working. Find the fault first. Disconnect each tool and cord in sequence and test the circuit after each disconnection to identify the faulted item. A GFCI that trips over and over is telling you there is a potentially lethal fault somewhere in the
4. Wet conditions and electricity are a critical combination. Never use electrical tools or extension cords in standing water or in rain. Keep extension cord connections off the floor — hang them from hooks or supports so they are not lying in construction debris that may be wet. If working in a space where water is present from plumbing work or weather intrusion, verify that all circuits are

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

Q1: Walk me to the nearest electrical panel on this site and show me where the GFCI breakers are.
Q2: What is the procedure if you receive an electrical shock, even a minor one?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Inspect extension cords for cuts, abrasions, and exposed wiring daily
- All 120V receptacles in construction areas must be GFCI-protected
- Never bypass or defeat a GFCI — if it trips repeatedly, find the fault
- Keep all electrical connections off the floor and out of all wet areas
- Use only double-insulated or properly grounded power tools

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.

CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 34

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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